MZUZU UNIVERSITY

FACULTY OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES

DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNICATION STUDIES

END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATIONS

COMM 1101: COMMUNICATION SKILLS I

DATE: Monday, 13 September, 2021 **TIME: 3 Hours**

(8-11AM)

Instruction: Answer **all** questions

QUESTION 1

A. Write brief notes on the following terms:

I. Examination telepathy **(2 marks)**
II. Examination rubrics **(2 marks)**
III. Study plan **(2 marks)**

B. People study for different reasons. Briefly explain **three** reasons why people spend time studying. **(3 marks)**

C. With relevant examples, briefly explain **three** tips for effective studying. **(3 marks)**

QUESTION 2

A. When using the APA style of referencing, one needs to use in-text citations and create a reference list. Briefly explain the difference between the two. **(2 marks)**

B. Study the information below and compile it into entries as they would appear in a reference list:

I. A book authored by Benson Banda and James Phiri titled "Poverty in Malawi" published by Dzuka Publishers based in Blantyre in 2010. **(4 marks)**

II. An article published by The Nation newspaper dated 08 September, 2021, authored by Joy Ndovi titled "Flames recover" found on page 26. **(4 marks)**

C. Explain briefly two instances where one uses:

I. **direct quotations** during citation **(2 marks)**

II. ***et al.*** during citation **(2 marks)**

QUESTION 3

A. Over the past months, the government has been mounting loud speakers on vehicles which have been going around towns and locations, urging people above 16 years old to go for COVID-19 vaccination. Which theory or model would you use to explain such a communication situation? Justify your answer. **(4 marks)**

B. Briefly explain the characteristics of human communication as reflected in the following statements:

I. I failed to communicate to him because he was not in his office. **(3 marks)**

II. The Matron was very understanding. She explained her position on the matter and allowed me to give my side of the issue making the discussion fruitful. **(3 marks)**

III. I told her that I could not attend to her because I was busy that time, but she felt that I was being rude. **(3 marks)**

IV. His face showed that he was very happy. **(3 marks)**

QUESTION 4

A. Distinguish between listening and hearing. **(1 mark)**

B. Using a classroom situation as an example, briefly describe the listening process. **(6 marks)**

C. Both the source and the receiver have a responsibility to develop awareness in the listening equation. As a receiver during a lecture, what **three** things would you do as part of your responsibility to make the listening successful? **(3 marks)**

D. Make outlining notes from the following passage:

Provided it is fitted with the right kind of input and output units, a computer can be programmed to carry out almost any task. As computers become more advanced, more uses for them are being found.

In factories, computer control is very important in maintaining the quality of the goods being made. Robots controlled by computers are being used more and more to do routine jobs day after day, without making mistakes or getting bored. Computers can help design new machines which can be tested by computer before the machines themselves are built. Computer graphics can show how a new design will work in all kinds of conditions. Transport is a good example of this. Computer-aided design and computer control on the production line has improved aircraft and cars, making them safer and less wasteful of fuel. Computers are very important in controlling the flying and navigation of aircraft, and they will soon do a similar job in the family car.

Another important field in which computers are making great advances is the handling of information. Large businesses put computers to work in data processing, which means calculating payrolls, sending bills, checking payments and generally keeping track of the way the business is being run. Computers can study this information and tell us how to run businesses more efficiently.

Computers can also hold stores of information called databases. The information can be sorted by the computer so that any part of it can very quickly be retrieved by anyone using the computer. Computer information services, such as Prestel, provide all kinds of information to the public over computer networks. The information provided is always up-to-date and it can come directly to your home from databases anywhere in the world.

Being able to obtain information in this way is obviously an aid to education. Computers are likely to play an important role in teaching. An educational computer programme can teach, adjusting its speed of progress to each student, and test their knowledge. So using the computer is like having a clever patient teacher in your home.

In medicine computers are used as scanners which look inside the body to find out if anything is wrong. Computers are also helpful in deciding the causes of illnesses; they can be told all the possible reasons for a patient's condition and then suggest the most likely one. They can help doctors make new drugs to fight illnesses, and computerized machines can help disabled people walk and live fuller lives. A special computer, for example, is able to read books to people with visual impairment.

However, computers need not always be so helpful. Modern warfare has used computers to make guns, missiles and other weapons very accurate and to improve warships, tanks and fighter aircraft. In future, a war may well be decided by which side has the best computers. Wars may also extend into space, a region that can only be explored with the aid of computers. Calculating the orbits of spacecraft and controlling their engines so that they follow the right course is work that cannot be done without computers. **(8 marks)**

END OF QUESTION PAPER